



FOSS Bytes

Red Hat gives open source perspective in Bilski case

Red Hat has filed an amicus brief with the US Supreme Court. In the brief, the company explains the practical problems of software patents to developers. The brief, filed in the Bilski case, asks the Supreme Court to adopt the lower court's machine-or-transformation test and to make clear that it excludes software



from patentability. The Bilski case involves the standard for patenting a process. The case concerns a business method patent, but involves many of the same issues as software patents. "Red Hat continues its commitment to the free and open source software community by taking a strong position against bad software patents," said Rob Tiller, vice president and assistant general counsel, IP for Red Hat. "Our patent

system is supposed to foster innovation, but for open source and software in general, it does the opposite. Software patents form a minefield that slows and discourages software innovation. The Bilski case presents a great opportunity for the Supreme Court to rectify this problem."

Ingres 9.3 offers easy migration from other databases

Ingres Corporation has launched Ingres Database 9.3 that offers easy migration from MySQL, as well as from proprietary databases such as Oracle, MS SQL Server, and Sybase. In this release, Ingres adds features commonly used in applications written for MySQL and Oracle to enable a smooth migration to Ingres. These features include improved accessibility of table procedures from within the query and the support of positional parameter notations that make database procedure invocation more flexible.

Ingres Database 9.3 also provides support for PAM, which enables the database to support more authentication mechanisms than previous versions. The new version adds the ability to automatically start multiple Data Access Servers to improve scalability in environments where large numbers of .Net and JDBC applications are connecting to Ingres. Ingres Database 9.3 is available for download at <http://esd.ingres.com>.

Digital Waves introduces T-Platforms' HPC Solutions

Bangalore-based IT solutions company Digital Waves and Russian supercomputer firm T-Platforms have inked a deal to "jointly offer high-performance computational clustering solutions to the Indian market." The new products available in India include the blade systems T-Blade 1.1 and T-Blade 2.0, PeakCell S server based on 9-core PowerXCell processors, and

ClusterX software for high-performance computing systems. The T-Blade 1.1 system chassis incorporates the computing power of 20 quad-core Intel Xeon 55xx (Nehalem) or six-core AMD Opteron 24xx (Istanbul) processors in a compact 5U enclosure, to give up to 9.98 TFlops of peak performance in a standard 42U rack. T-Blade 2.0 is the second generation of T-Platforms blade

platforms designed for building compute systems with a Petascale level of performance. It provides peak performance of up to 3TFlops in a 7U enclosure and up to 18TFlops in a standard 42U rack. The PeakCell S server is based on the PowerXCell 8i 9-core processor. The server has a peak performance of 204.8 GFlops for double precision operations and 409.6 GFlops for single precision operations, packed in a convenient 1U form factor.



Developing employee-savvy software gets Om Logistics Peace Award

World Without Wars has awarded S K Goel, vice president, IT, Om Logistics Ltd, with the inaugural Peace Award for promoting technologies that struggle against violence (monopolies). Goel has been conferred this award for developing Linux software and making it employee savvy. The World March, initiated by World Without Wars—an international organisation launched by the Humanist Movement—began in New Zealand on October 2, 2009. It will conclude in the Andes Mountains (Punta de Vacas, Aconcagua, Argentina) on January 2, 2010, after covering more than 90 countries around the globe.

MIPS joins Open Handset Alliance

MIPS Technologies, a provider of processor architectures and cores, has announced that it has joined the Open Handset Alliance, a group of more than 45 technology and mobile companies working to offer consumers a richer, less expensive, and better mobile experience. As a member, MIPS Technologies will work with others to contribute to the continued development and success of the Android platform. It's already an active contributor to Android development, recently making its source code optimised for the MIPS architecture, publicly available. As part of its relationship with the Open Handset Alliance, MIPS will contribute the Android on MIPS' code to the Android Open Source Project.

